

RECONSTRUCTION

DOUBLET
AND HOSE

Closely based on the pourpoint (quilted doublet) of Charles de Blois, dated to 1364 and housed in the Musée des Tissus in Lyon, this sumptuous blue silk paltock (doublet) with brocaded gilt leaves is the work of reconstruction dressmaker Sarah Thursfield. A feature of the garment is the deep armhole shape evolved to allow a skintight but non-restrictive fit on heavily muscled fighting men. Although both this version and the original are covered in expensive silk, plain linen doublets were usually made for the battlefield. The long hose are suspended from points laced inside the doublet, and the feet are soled with leather to create the shape of fashionable shoes. They would be worn with wooden pattens if needed.

